

Keyboard shortcuts that speed up formatting, editing and navigation in Microsoft Word — grouped by what you're trying to do.

Formatting Text

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl + B	Bold the selected text.
Ctrl + I	Italicize the selected text.
Ctrl + U	Underline the selected text.
Ctrl + Shift + >	Increase font size.
Ctrl + Shift + <	Decrease font size.
Ctrl + E	Center-align the paragraph.
Ctrl + L	Left-align the paragraph.
Ctrl + R	Right-align the paragraph.
Ctrl + J	Justify the paragraph.

Editing & Selecting

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl + C / Ctrl + X / Ctrl + V	Copy / Cut / Paste.
Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y	Undo / Redo the last action.
Ctrl + A	Select the entire document.
Ctrl + Shift + Right/Left Arrow	Select one word at a time.
Ctrl + F	Open Find, to search for text.
Ctrl + H	Open Find & Replace.
Double-click a word	Select that whole word.
Triple-click a line	Select the whole paragraph.

Navigating a Document

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl + Home / Ctrl + End	Jump to the very start / end of the document.
Ctrl + Right/Left Arrow	Jump one word at a time.
Ctrl + Down/Up Arrow	Jump one paragraph at a time.
Page Up / Page Down	Scroll up or down one screen.
Ctrl + G	Go to a specific page or line number.

Working with Documents

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl + N	Open a new blank document.
Ctrl + O	Open an existing document.
Ctrl + S	Save the document.
F12	Save As (save a copy with a new name).
Ctrl + P	Print the document.
Ctrl + Enter	Insert a page break.
Ctrl + K	Insert a hyperlink.

Tip: most of these shortcuts work the same way in PowerPoint, Excel and most other Windows apps too — learn them once, use them everywhere.

Want to go from these shortcuts to confidently formatting full documents, CVs and reports? That's exactly what we cover in our Professional Computer Basics Course.